A Study of Something Interesting

Towards a Better Understanding of the Problem

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Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of

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October 2026

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To everyone who asked "is it done yet?" — almost.

Declaration

I hereby declare that this thesis is my own work and that it has not been submitted for any other degree or qualification. All sources of information have been acknowledged by means of references.

_____

Jane Q. Doe
October 2026

Preface

This thesis grew out of a simple question that turned out to be far from simple. This preface records the motivation and the scope of the work, and explains how the chapters fit together.

The structure is as follows. Chapter 2 reviews the template styles and parameters, Chapter 3 describes the document elements, Chapter 4 covers tables and figures, Chapter 5 mathematics, and Chapter 6 citations and bibliographies. Chapter 7 concludes.

Acknowledgements

I am grateful to my supervisor, Prof. Ada Lovelace, for her patient guidance, and to Dr. Alan Turing for many stimulating discussions. Thanks also go to my colleagues and family for their support.

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Jane Q. Doe

Supervisor: Prof. Ada Lovelace

Co-supervisor: Dr. Alan Turing

Abstract

This thesis investigates an interesting problem and proposes a method to address it. We present a formal treatment, an implementation, and an empirical evaluation. The results show that the proposed method improves upon the state of the art on standard benchmarks.

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Chapter 1

Introduction

ACM's consolidated article template, introduced in 2017, provides a consistent LaTeX style for use across ACM publications, and incorporates accessibility and metadata-extraction functionality necessary for future Digital Library endeavors. Numerous ACM and SIG-specific LaTeX templates have been examined, and their unique features incorporated into this single new template.

This thesis template builds on that work. Where the ACM template is a single article, this document is arranged by chapter and provides the usual parts of a thesis: a cover page, a table of contents, lists of figures and tables, an abstract, the main chapters, a bibliography, and special parts such as the declaration, preface and acknowledgements.

If you are new to LaTeX, this document doubles as a guide to preparing your thesis. If you have used the ACM template before, it shows how its features map onto the structure of a thesis.

1.1 Outline

Chapter 2 reviews the template styles and parameters. Chapter 3 describes the document elements, from typefaces to sectioning. Chapter 4 covers tables and figures, Chapter 5 mathematics, and Chapter 6 citations and bibliographies. Chapter 7 concludes.

Chapter 2

Template Overview

As noted in the introduction, this document class can be used to prepare many different renderings of the same thesis — a copy for review, a clean copy for printing and binding, and a copy for reading on screen — all by selecting the appropriate *template style* and *template parameters*.

This document explains the major features of the document class. For further information on the original ACM class, the *LaTeX User's Guide* is available from https://www.acm.org/publications/proceedings-template.

2.1 Template Styles

The primary parameter given to the document class is the *template style*, which corresponds to the intended use of the output. This parameter is enclosed in square brackets and is a part of the `documentclass` command:

```
\documentclass[STYLE]{thesis}
```

The thesis template defines three styles:

- `print`: a two-sided (duplex) copy with binding margins, suitable for printing and binding. This is the default.
- `screen`: a one-sided copy for reading on screen, with coloured hyperlinks.
- `review`: a one-sided reading copy with line numbers.

2.2 Template Parameters

In addition to specifying the *template style*, there are a number of *template parameters* which modify some part of the applied template style. The base

font size is 14 pt by default, and 10, 11, 12, 17 and 20 pt are also accepted. Frequently-used parameters include:

- `onehalf`, `double`: line spacing.
- `font=times`: a Times-like text face (`font=libertine` is the default).
- `authoryear`: author–year citations.
- `biblatex`: use BibLaTeX with the `acmnumeric` or `acmauthoryear` styles instead of BibTeX.

Testing the listing

- Something
- Another one

This document uses the following string as the first command in the source file:

```
\documentclass[print]{thesis}
```

2.3 Files and Building

The template is built with the usual LaTeX tools. With `latexmk`:

```
latexmk -pdf thesis.tex
```

or, manually, `pdflatex`, then `bibtex`, then `pdflatex` twice more. A full TeX Live (or MiKTeX) installation is required; the class uses the standard packages `extsizes`, `libertine`, `newtxmath`, `geometry`, `titlesec`, `fancyhdr`, `setspace`, `natbib`, `hyperref`, `microtype`, `booktabs`, `amsmath` and `amsthm`.

The entry point is `thesis.tex`, and the files are laid out as follows:

```
thesis.cls    the thesis class (structure, typography)
cover.sty     the cover page
thesis.tex        entry point
frontmatter/      cover metadata and the preliminary parts
chapters/         the main chapters
backmatter/       the appendices
references.bib    your bibliography
```

2.4 Document Structure

The document is divided in the usual way:

- `\frontmatter` — the cover, dedication, declaration, preface, acknowledgements and abstract, numbered in roman numerals;
- `\mainmatter` — the chapters, numbered in arabic;
- `\backmatter` — the bibliography and the appendices.

The preliminary parts use the `frontchapter` environment, which takes the title you give it and starts an unnumbered, table-of-contents listed page:

```
\begin{frontchapter}[Declaration]
  ... the declaration text ...
\end{frontchapter}
```

(The title may also be given in braces, `\begin{frontchapter}{Declaration}`.) The abstract is a special page with its own `abstract` environment. Each preliminary part is kept in its own file under `frontmatter/` and simply included from `thesis.tex`.

2.5 Modifications

The class is meant to be used as-is. Adjusting margins, typeface sizes, line spacing, paragraph and list definitions, and the use of the `\vspace` command to manually adjust the vertical spacing between elements of your work should be done with care, as these settings often need to satisfy the requirements of your institution.

Chapter 3

Document Elements

This chapter describes the individual elements of which a thesis is composed, from the typeface to the sectioning commands.

3.1 Typefaces

The document class requires the use of the "Libertine" typeface family. Your TEX installation should include this set of packages. Please do not substitute other typefaces. The "`lmodern`" and "`ltimes`" packages should not be used, as they will override the built-in typeface families.

3.2 Title Information

The title of your work should use capital letters appropriately — https://capitalizemytitle.com/ has useful rules for capitalization. Set the title and subtitle with the standard `\title` command and the `\subtitle` command:

```
\title{The Name of the Title Is Hope}
\subtitle{A Short Subtitle}
```

Do not insert line breaks in your title.

3.3 Metadata

The cover page is kept apart from the thesis class. It is provided by the `cover` package, loaded and fed from the preamble:

```
\usepackage{cover}
\input{frontmatter/cover}
```

The metadata file uses familiar ACM-style commands:

```
\author{Ben Trovato}
\affiliation{Department of Computer Science\\
             University of Somewhere}
\email{trovato@corporation.com}
\orcid{1234-5678-9012}
\authornote{Corresponding author.}

\degree{Doctor of Philosophy}
\supervisor{Prof.\ Ada Lovelace}
\cosupervisor{Dr.\ Alan Turing}
\submissiondate{October 2026}
```

Each value can be printed in the document with the corresponding accessor, for example `\theauthor`, `\theaffiliation` and `\thesubmissiondate`.

The cover itself is produced by `\maketitle`. To customise its layout, redefine `\maketitle` (or edit `cover.sty`) using the accessors, for example:

```
\renewcommand{\maketitle}{%
  \begin{titlepage}\centering
    {\Huge\bfseries\thetitle\par}\vspace{2cm}
    {\LARGE\theauthor\par}
  \end{titlepage}}
```

3.4 Sectioning Commands

Your work should use standard LaTeX sectioning commands: `\chapter`, `\section`, `\subsection`, `\subsubsection`, `\paragraph`, and `\subparagraph`. The sectioning levels up to `\subsubsection` should be numbered; do not remove the numbering from the commands.

Simulating a sectioning command by setting the first word or words of a paragraph in boldface or italicized text is **not allowed.**

Below are examples of sectioning commands.

3.4.1 Subsection

This is a subsection.

Subsubsection

This is a subsubsection.

Paragraph This is a paragraph.

Subparagraph This is a subparagraph.

3.5 Multi-language Documents

Documents may be written in languages other than English, or include titles, subtitles and abstracts in different languages. As a rule, a document written in a language other than English should also include an English title and abstract. The metadata commands accept arbitrary text, so translated titles and abstracts can be set alongside the main ones.

Chapter 4

Tables and Figures

4.1 Tables

The document class includes the "booktabs" package — https://ctan.org/pkg/booktabs — for preparing high-quality tables.

Table captions are placed *above* the table.

Because tables cannot be split across pages, the best placement for them is typically the top of the page nearest their initial cite. To ensure this proper "floating" placement of tables, use the environment **table** to enclose the table's contents and the table caption. The contents of the table itself must go in the **tabular** environment, to be aligned properly in rows and columns, with the desired horizontal and vertical rules.

Immediately following this sentence is the point at which Table 4.1 is included in the input file; compare the placement of the table here with the table in the printed output of this document.

Table 4.1: Frequency of Special Characters

Non-English or Math	Frequency	Comments
Ø	1 in 1,000	For Swedish names
π	1 in 5	Common in math
\$	4 in 5	Used in business
Ψ_1^2	1 in 40,000	Unexplained usage

To set a wider table, which takes up the whole width of the page's live area, use the environment **table*** to enclose the table's contents and the table

caption. As with a single-column table, this wide table will "float" to a location deemed more desirable. Immediately following this sentence is the point at which Table 4.2 is included in the input file; again, it is instructive to compare the placement of the table here with the table in the printed output of this document.

Table 4.2: Some Typical Commands

Command	A Number	Comments
`\author`	100	Author
`\table`	300	For tables
`\table*`	400	For wider tables

Always use midrule to separate table header rows from data rows, and use it only for this purpose. This enables assistive technologies to recognise table headers and support their users in navigating tables more easily.

4.2 Figures

The "`figure`" environment should be used for figures. One or more images can be placed within a figure. If your figure contains third-party material, you must clearly identify it as such, as shown in the example below.

Your figures should contain a caption which describes the figure to the reader.

Figure captions are placed *below* the figure.

Every figure should also have a figure description unless it is purely decorative. These descriptions convey what is in the image to someone who cannot see it. They are also used by search engine crawlers for indexing images, and when images cannot be loaded.

A figure description must be unformatted plain text less than 2000 characters long (including spaces). **Figure descriptions should not repeat the figure caption – their purpose is to capture important information that is not already provided in the caption or the main text of the paper.**

4.2.1 Full-width Figures

An image, or set of images in one figure, that spans the page is created with the **figure*** environment, in the same way as a wide table:



Figure 4.1: 1907 Franklin Model D roadster. Photograph by Harris & Ewing, Inc. [Public domain], via Wikimedia Commons. (https://goo.gl/VLCRBB).

```
\begin{figure*}
  \includegraphics[width=\textwidth]{sampleteaser}
  \caption{figure caption}
  \Description{figure description}
\end{figure*}
```



Figure 4.2: Seattle Mariners at Spring Training, 2010.

Chapter 5

Mathematics

You may want to display math equations in three distinct styles: inline, numbered or non-numbered display. Each of the three are discussed in the next sections.

5.1 Inline (In-text) Equations

A formula that appears in the running text is called an inline or in-text formula. It is produced by the **math** environment, which can be invoked with the usual `\begin . . . \end` construction or with the short form `$ . . . $`. You can use any of the symbols and structures, from α to ω, available in LaTeX [25]; this section will simply show a few examples of in-text equations in context. Notice how this equation: $\lim_{n\to\infty} x = 0$, set here in in-line math style, looks slightly different when set in display style. (See next section).

5.2 Display Equations

A numbered display equation—one set off by vertical space from the text and centered horizontally—is produced by the **equation** environment. An unnumbered display equation is produced by the **displaymath** environment.

Again, in either environment, you can use any of the symbols and structures available in LaTeX; this section will just give a couple of examples of display equations in context. First, consider the equation, shown as an inline equation above:

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} x = 0 \tag{5.1}$$

Notice how it is formatted somewhat differently in the **displaymath** environ-

ment. Now, we'll enter an unnumbered equation:

$$\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} x + 1$$

and follow it with another numbered equation:

$$\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} x_i = \int_0^{\pi+2} f \tag{5.2}$$

just to demonstrate LaTeX's able handling of numbering.

Chapter 6

Citations and Bibliographies

The use of BibTEX for the preparation and formatting of one's references is strongly recommended. Authors' names should be complete — use full first names ("Donald E. Knuth") not initials ("D. E. Knuth") — and the salient identifying features of a reference should be included: title, year, volume, number, pages, article DOI, etc.

The bibliography is included in your source document with these two commands, placed just before the `\end{document}` command:

```
\bibliographystyle{ACM-Reference-Format}
\bibliography{bibfile}
```

where "`bibfile`" is the name, without the "`.bib`" suffix, of the BibTEX file. The class loads the `ACM-Reference-Format` style by default.

Citations and references are numbered by default. A small number of documents use citations and references formatted in the "author year" style; for these, pass the `authoryear` parameter to the document class:

```
\documentclass[print, authoryear]{thesis}
```

Some examples follow. A paginated journal article [2], an enumerated journal article [11], a reference to an entire issue [10], a monograph (whole book) [24], a monograph/whole book in a series [18], a divisible-book such as an anthology or compilation [13] followed by the same example where only the series is output if the volume number is given [14], a chapter in a divisible book [37], a chapter in a divisible book in a series [12], a multi-volume work as book

[23], a couple of articles in a proceedings [3, 16], a proceedings article with all possible elements [36], an example of an enumerated proceedings article [15], an informally published work [17], a couple of preprints [6, 8], a doctoral dissertation [9], a master's thesis [4], an online document [1, 29, 38], a video game [26–28], a patent [35], work accepted for publication [32], and a few works by a prolific author [33, 34]. Other cites might contain 'duplicate' DOI and URLs (some SIAM articles) [22]. Multi-volume works as books [20] and [19]. A presentation [31]. An article under review [7]. A couple of citations with DOIs: [21, 22]. Online citations: [38–40]. Artifacts: [30] and [5].

Chapter 7

Conclusion

This thesis template adapts the ACM article template to the structure of a thesis. It keeps the typography and the workflow ideas of the original — review, print and screen renderings — while organising the document by chapter and adding the parts that a thesis requires: a cover page, a table of contents, lists of figures and tables, an abstract, a bibliography, and special parts such as the declaration, preface and acknowledgements.

7.1 Further Reading

For further information, the *LaTeX User's Guide* and the ACM template documentation are valuable references.

7.2 Ethics and Privacy Statement

This section of your work should discuss the potential societal risks that might result from its publication. The privacy and ethics statement should clearly address the broader impacts of the work as it relates to your interpretation of privacy, fairness, safety, human rights, data sovereignty, or future misuse, and any benefit/risk trade-off resulting from the research. We acknowledge that some theses may have minimal societal risks beyond those considered by institutional review boards, and the dimensions considered by any review of the study design or dataset licenses could be provided in this statement.

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Appendix A

Supplementary Material

A.1 Research Methods

A.1.1 Part One

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Morbi malesuada, quam in pulvinar varius, metus nunc fermentum urna, id sollicitudin purus odio sit amet enim. Aliquam ullamcorper eu ipsum vel mollis. Curabitur quis dictum nisl. Phasellus vel semper risus, et lacinia dolor. Integer ultricies commodo sem nec semper.

A.1.2 Part Two

Etiam commodo feugiat nisl pulvinar pellentesque. Etiam auctor sodales ligula, non varius nibh pulvinar semper. Suspendisse nec lectus non ipsum convallis congue hendrerit vitae sapien. Donec at laoreet eros. Vivamus non purus placerat, scelerisque diam eu, cursus ante. Etiam aliquam tortor auctor efficitur mattis.

A.2 Online Resources

Nam id fermentum dui. Suspendisse sagittis tortor a nulla mollis, in pulvinar ex pretium. Sed interdum orci quis metus euismod, et sagittis enim maximus. Vestibulum gravida massa ut felis suscipit congue. Quisque mattis elit a risus ultrices commodo venenatis eget dui. Etiam sagittis eleifend elementum.

Nam interdum magna at lectus dignissim, ac dignissim lorem rhoncus. Maecenas eu arcu ac neque placerat aliquam. Nunc pulvinar massa et mattis

lacinia.